PHASE 1 AUDIT · THE BUSINESS CASE & PHASE 2 PROPOSAL

Notion Orchestration Layer

Argos Multilingual

Frontier AI Data Services BU

What the current way of working consumes each year, what the layer gives back, and how long it takes to pay for itself. Every volume in this pack was returned by your own team.

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12 AUGUST 2026 · CONFIDENTIAL

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What we will cover

01 / 06

What we found

Three hours of your team's honesty, and two walkthroughs of the systems underneath.

PHASE 1 · RL-2026-ARG-P1

What this audit covered

3h	9	4	32
WORKSHOP, FULL TEAM	PARTICIPANTS, 6 FUNCTIONS	CALLS & WALKTHROUGHS	DATA SOURCES MAPPED

WHAT WE DID

- Discovery calls with the Program Director and the GM, 6 and 13 July
- End-to-end process workshop with all functions, 23 July
- Supply chain system walkthrough: XTRF, Vendra, the trackers, 29 July
- Delivery system walkthrough: XTRF, Myriad, the PM tracker, 3 August

WHAT YOU WALKED OUT WITH

- A validated end-to-end map, from client request to freelancer paid
- A tool inventory with a decision on every single one
- One morning screen defined by each role, in their own words
- This findings pack, and the Statement of Work behind it

FINDINGS

Four things, and they are all the same thing

/ F1 · ORCHESTRATION

You have systems of record. You have no orchestration layer.

XTRF knows the money. Myriad knows the production. Nobody knows the state of the work.

Every role asked for the same thing first: one screen.

/ F2 · DUPLICATION

The same fact is typed up to eight times.

One vendor on one batch exists in eleven places. Two teams copy the same facts to each other, line by line.

"Supply chain does not interact with our trackers."

/ F3 · MARGIN

Your margin lives in one person's spreadsheet.

Buy rate, sell rate and margin per vendor exist in the supply chain master tracker, and nowhere you can query.

Not visible on any dashboard, by anyone.

/ F4 · FRAUD

Fraud screening is a manual tax that grows with you.

CVs reviewed one by one. Candidates declare one country and enter another. Interviews scheduled by hand.

It scales with volume. Your ambition is thousands.

02 / 06

The tool landscape

Everything the BU runs on, and where a single fact actually lives.

THE INVENTORY

What one business unit runs on

22 APPLICATIONS

10 SPREADSHEET FAMILIES

APPLICATIONS

XTRF · Myriad · Asana · Vendra · Google Sheets · Google Drive · SharePoint · Outlook · Teams · Slack · Upwork

TangoCard · LinkedIn · GMS · Social ads · inATS · HubSpot · Salesforce · Tableau · Jira · Notion · Zoom / Meet

SPREADSHEETS, WHERE THE ORCHESTRATION ACTUALLY HAPPENS

- S1 · Supply chain master tracker
- S2 · Vendor / referral tracker
- S3 · Weekly payment report
- S4 · PM project tracker (one per PM)
- S5 · PM reference tab
- S6 · PM contacted tab
- S7 · QA team trackers
- S8 · Myriad payment export
- S9 · Dev standup tracker
- S10 · Queries tracker

The orchestration lives in none of the 22 applications. It lives in the spreadsheets, several of them personal, held together by copy-paste between people.

WHAT MOVES

Five tools die. Three stay. One layer appears.

REPLACED — THEIR CONTENT POURS INTO NOTION

- Asana →
- S1 · Supply chain master tracker →
- S2 · Vendor / referral tracker →
- S4-S6 · PM project trackers →
- S7 · QA team trackers →
- S9-S10 · Standup & queries →

THE ORCHESTRATION LAYER

Notion

Projects	Batches
Vendors	Staffing
QA Checks	Tasks
Meetings	Clients

Written once. Read by everyone.

KEPT — CONNECTED, NEVER REWRITTEN

- ↔ XTRF · money
- ↔ Myriad · production
- ↔ Vendra · paperwork
- ↔ Drive · files
- ↔ Outlook / Teams · talking
- ↔ Upwork / TangoCard · paying

Nothing you rely on gets switched off. What disappears is the spreadsheet layer that was holding the other tools together by hand.

THE PRINCIPLE

Write once, read everywhere

A fact is entered one time, by the person closest to it, and it appears everywhere it is needed. Three real examples from your own operation.

	TODAY	AFTER
"This vendor is excluded, no response"	The PM writes it in her tracker, then opens the supply chain tracker and copies it across one by one. If she does not, supply chain never knows and the next project contacts the person again.	One field. It appears on the Supply Chain Board, on the vendor record with its reason, in the funnel counts, and in the team memory next year.
"The agreed buy rate is 20 USD"	Negotiated by supply chain, typed into the master tracker, copied by the PM into her tracker, typed again into XTRF at PO time. Three entries, three chances to diverge.	Entered once. Margin computes itself, rolls up to the project, and lands on your dashboard against target.
"Test result: borderline"	Quality writes it in their tracker, then re-enters it in the PM's tracker in order to talk to them. Supply chain reads it somewhere else again.	One record. It updates the vendor history, the funnel, the performance flag and the Quality Board, in the same second.

One owner, one home, and everyone else gets a view, never a copy. That is the difference between ten spreadsheets and one system, and it is why the trackers can actually die.

Where the hours actually go

Supply chain shared inbox
you said 20-30 h/wk per person → 20 × 45 wks, **1 person only** = 900 h
900 h

Answering vendor queries during production
you said 10 h/wk → 10 × 45 wks = 450 h
450 h

Re-typing the same fact from one tracker into another
you said 8 h/wk → 8 × 45 wks = 360 h
360 h

Sourcing and the referral tracker
you said 6-8 h/wk → 6 × 45 wks = 270 h
270 h

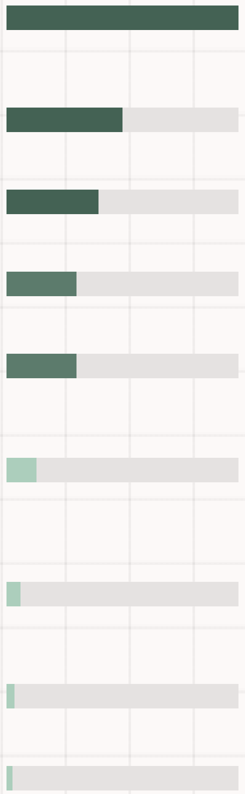
The weekly payment report and Upwork releases
you said 6 h/wk → 6 × 45 wks = 270 h
270 h

Purchase orders typed by hand
you said 50 POs/project, 35+ projects/yr → 35 × 50 × 4 min ÷ 60 = 117 h
117 h

Onboarding vendors one by one
you said 30-50/month → 30 × 12 × 8.5 min ÷ 60 = 51 h
51 h

Project closure and case-study prep
you said 1 h per closed project → 1 × 35 = 35 h
35 h

Fraud screening, CV by CV
you said 50-100/month → 50 × 12 × 3 min ÷ 60 = 30 h
30 h



TOTAL, ON THE LOW END OF EVERY RANGE

2,480 h/year

≈ 1.4 full-time people, doing nothing but moving facts between places.

ON THE HIGH END OF THE SAME RANGES

4,470 h ≈ 2.5 people

2 people on the inbox at 30 h/wk, 50 vendors/month, 100 applications/month.

HOW THE TOTAL IS BUILT

900 + 450 + 360 + 270 + 270 + 117 + 51 + 35 + 30 = **2,483 h**, rounded to 2,480.
2,480 ÷ 1,750 h per full-time person = **1.4**.

45 working weeks a year. A5 and B3 not returned, so not counted.

None of this is a people problem. It is one structural problem: the work has no home, so people are the integration layer. You are paying 1.4 to 2.5 salaries for that job.

What it costs

The cause underneath the four findings, the number it produces every year, and the three ways that money comes back.

THE ROOT CAUSE

Your tools each own a noun. Nobody owns the verb.

XTRF owns the money. Myriad owns the production. Vendra owns the paperwork. Every tool holds a thing. Not one of them holds the work in progress, so the only place it exists is in spreadsheets and in people's heads. That is why adding a tool has never fixed it, and why Asana did not stick.

IF NOTHING CHANGES

Every hour on the previous slide is linear in volume. Your own answer on applications was "50 to 100 a month, and this needs to increase x100". At 3 minutes a CV, screened one by one, x100 is 3,000 to 6,000 hours a year: between 1.7 and 3.4 extra people hired to read CVs, before a single one is onboarded.

The team does not break at 2x. It breaks where the growth plan meets a process that only scales by hiring.

WHERE WE ARE GOING

TODAY	AFTER
Four trackers, one per team, none talking	One staffing line, read by everyone
Margin in a private spreadsheet column	Margin against target, on your screen
40 POs typed from a manual export	The lines assembled, ready to issue
Quality tracked nowhere	Every check owned, scored and attached to the vendor
"I ask people for movement updates"	One screen, every morning, no meeting

THE COST OF DOING NOTHING

The hours are yours. So is the rate.

We have deliberately not picked a loaded hourly cost for you. Find your blended figure in the left column and read across: that row is your number, built on volumes your own team returned.

Annual cost = hours × your loaded hourly cost. Example on the highlighted row: **2,480 h × 40 € = 99,200 €**. High-end column: **4,470 h × 40 € = 178,800 €**.

BLENDED LOADED COST	CONSERVATIVE · 2,480 H	HIGH END · 4,470 H
25 € / hour	62,000 €	111,750 €
30 € / hour	74,400 €	134,100 €
40 € / hour	**99,200 €**	178,800 €
50 € / hour	124,000 €	223,500 €

EVERY YEAR

This is not a one-off cost. It is paid again in full every twelve months, and it grows with volume.

NOTHING INVENTED

Nine measured tasks, volumes returned by your team on 11 August, the low end of every range they gave.

STILL UNDERSTATED

Visibility rebuilt by hand was not costed at all, and neither was the Asana licence. Both only push the number up.

THE RETURN

Three ways this pays back, and only the first one is a cost saving

01 · HOURS GIVEN BACK

1,140 h / year

Roughly two thirds of a full-time person, given back every year. The re-typing disappears, not the judgement: facts are entered once by the person closest to them. We show the haircut line by line later in this pack rather than claiming the gross 2,480.

MEASURABLE FROM MONTH ONE

02 · MARGIN YOU CAN DEFEND

35+ projects a year

Buy rate, sell rate and margin per vendor exist today in one column of one private spreadsheet. Nobody can query them, so nobody defends them mid-project. After: margin computes on every staffing line, rolls up to the project and sits on your screen against target.

ONE POINT OF MARGIN RECOVERED ACROSS THE PORTFOLIO OUTWEIGHS THIS ENTIRE ENGAGEMENT

03 · CAPACITY TO GROW

x100 applications

Your stated target, in your own words on the data sheet. Screening, onboarding and PO issuing are linear in headcount today, so x100 volume means hiring in proportion. The layer breaks that line: volume goes up, the manual minutes do not.

THE GROWTH PLAN IS WHAT MAKES THIS URGENT

The cost saving alone already justifies the fee. Margin visibility and growth capacity are why this is worth doing now rather than next year.

The system

One orchestration layer on top of the systems you keep.

TARGET ARCHITECTURE

Notion orchestrates. XTRF and Myriad keep what they own.

NOTION · THE ORCHESTRATION LAYER (NEW)

Projects
One status carries the 12 phases

Batches
The unit of work, of PO and of quality

Vendors
One status carries the whole funnel

Project Staffing
Vendor × project, rates and margin

QA Checks
Quality, as a layer across everything

Tasks
Every function converges here

Meetings
Transcript in, notes and tasks out

Clients
The delivery-side record

XTRF · KEPT, UNTOUCHED

Profiles, price list, jobs, POs, client invoices, revenue. Vendors invoice themselves there.

Bridge: XTRF project ID + PO reference

MYRIAD · KEPT, UNTOUCHED

Where annotators work. One project per batch, payment report export.

Bridge: Myriad project + volume processed

No writes into XTRF. No changes to Myriad. Two bridges, one direction each. Notion never becomes a second rate engine.

YOUR MORNING SCREEN

GM Command Center

"A full funnel end-to-end view. So I don't have to bug everyone on this call on a continual basis to provide movement updates."

Argos · Data Services

- GM Command Center
- Program Cockpit
- Delivery Board
- Quality Board
- Supply Chain Board
- Projects
- Batches
- Vendors
- QA Checks

Argos / Dashboards / GM Command Center ILLUSTRATIVE · SAMPLE FIGURES, NOT YOUR DATA

GM Command Center

Board Table Timeline Financials

Scoping 5	Sourcing 4	In production 8	Delivered 6
Vega · Evaluation Annotation	Atlas · Data collection Blocked gap 120 vendors	AGI-DS · Word Alignment At risk 62% staffed · batch 2	Orion · Annotation Invoiced
Nova · Transcription Transcription		Hermes · Speech On track	

▸ Portfolio financials rollup from staffing lines

Project	Risk	Staffed	Margin	vs target
AGI-DS	At risk	62%	34%	-8
Hermes	On track	91%	45%	+3
Portfolio			38%	target 42%

SIX MORE, ONE PER ROLE: Program Cockpit · Delivery Board · Quality Board · Supply Chain Board · Solutions Board · Project One-Pager

WHY THIS APPROACH

The three alternatives, taken seriously

VS TURNING ON XTRF WORKFLOWS

A fair question, and worth asking internally: XTRF ships a workflow engine, templates and job offers, and other Argos teams use them. This BU does not.

But XTRF orchestrates XTRF. It does not orchestrate Myriad, Vendra, Asana, Drive, Outlook and ten spreadsheets. The gap is between the tools, which is exactly where XTRF cannot reach.

VS YOUR INTERNAL VENDOR PORTAL

You already have a requirements document for a single vendor management system. It is a good project and it stays yours.

It solves the vendor-facing side. It does not give the PM, Quality or leadership a view of the work. The two are complementary, and this layer is the data foundation the portal would read from anyway.

VS DOING NOTHING THIS YEAR

Defensible if volumes were flat. They are not: the stated ambition is thousands of vendors per project.

Every cost in this pack scales linearly with that. The spreadsheets do not fail loudly, they fail as a slow tax on every person, and by then the knowledge has already left with whoever owned the file.

One finding worth acting on regardless of this proposal: check whether the XTRF Vendor Portal module is already in your licence. Your vendors already log in and invoice there.

05 / 06

The plan

Three sprints, the timeline, and what we need from you.

THREE SPRINTS

Three sprints, live on 23 October

SPRINT 1 · 14-25 SEP

Project backbone

Projects, Batches, Clients, Tasks, Meetings. The 12-phase lifecycle, the intake form, the Program Cockpit and the Project One-Pager. Piloted on 2-3 live projects.

SPRINT 2 · 28 SEP-9 OCT

Vendor funnel & quality

Vendors, Staffing with rates and margin, QA Checks, the sourcing form, onboarding and offboarding checklists, the fraud flag and its review queue, the Supply Chain Board.

SPRINT 3 · 12-23 OCT

Screens, AI, adoption

The seven morning screens, the XTRF bridge automations, the Meeting Agent, the SOP pack, and two full days of training. Go-live.

WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

- Admin access to a Notion workspace on the Business plan with AI
- Read access to Asana, the project Drive folders and the four trackers
- 2-3 live projects for the Sprint 1 pilot, and a tracker export for Sprint 2
- The named people who clear a flagged candidate
- One champion per function for training and adoption

WHY SEPTEMBER

Starting mid-September rather than in August puts the build after the summer, when your Program Director is back from leave and your teams are at full strength. She owns most of what Sprint 1 needs.

It also means the pilot runs on live autumn projects rather than on a half-staffed August, which is the difference between a system that gets adopted and one that gets looked at.

We do not claim to remove all 2,480 hours

A layer that writes once and reads everywhere kills the re-typing. It does not kill the conversations. Here is the haircut, line by line, so the return below is one you can defend rather than one you have to believe.

LINE	TODAY	REMOVED	SAVED
Re-typing one fact from tracker to tracker entered once, read everywhere	360 h	90%	324 h
Weekly payment report becomes a view on the batches	270 h	70%	189 h
Sourcing and the referral tracker the funnel replaces the spreadsheet	270 h	60%	162 h
Purchase orders lines assembled, a human still issues	117 h	70%	82 h
Project closure the data is already in the project	35 h	70%	25 h
Onboarding vendors checklist and form, no batch until option A	51 h	50%	26 h
Fraud screening flag and review queue, a human still decides	30 h	50%	15 h
Vendor queries in production logged and templated, still answered by a person	450 h	30%	135 h
Supply chain shared inbox Phase 2 does not touch the alias. Option A does.	900 h	20%	180 h

GIVEN BACK, EVERY YEAR

1,140 h

Out of 2,480. That is **46%**, and every figure below is built on this number, not on the gross one.

STILL MANUAL AFTER

1,340 h

Mostly the inbox and the vendor conversations. Option A, the vendor portal, is what attacks those, and it is deliberately not in this fee.

A one-off fee against a cost you pay every year

PHASE 2A + 2B, ONE-OFF

18,500 €

EXCL. VAT · 50% KICKOFF, 50% GO-LIVE

GIVEN BACK, EVERY YEAR

28,500 – 57,000 €

The 1,140 hours of the previous page, priced between 25 and 50 € an hour. Not the gross 2,480.

IF YOUR RATE IS	GIVEN BACK / YEAR	PAYBACK	YEAR-ONE NET
25 € / h	28,500 €	7.8 months	10,000 € net
30 € / h	34,200 €	6.5 months	15,700 € net
40 € / h	**45,600 €**	**4.9 months**	**27,100 € net**
50 € / h	57,000 €	3.9 months	38,500 € net

Payback = 18,500 € ÷ given back per year × 12 months. Highlighted row: 18,500 ÷ 45,600 × 12 = **4.9 months**. Year-one net = given back − fee.

Worst case on this page: the fee is back inside the first year, on 46% of the hours, before a single point of margin is recovered and before the Asana licence is switched off.

GO-LIVE 23 OCTOBER

Breakeven lands between February and June 2027 on these figures.

YEAR TWO ONWARD

The fee is not paid again. What it gives back is. Only the optional Operate run continues, at 1,500 € a month.

IF WE ARE HALF WRONG AGAIN

Halve the 1,140 hours on top of the haircut and the fee still returns inside 24 months.

The next two years, with and without the layer

Cumulative cost from go-live, at 40 € an hour, with volumes held flat. Flat is the assumption that works against us: your own target is growth.

CUMULATIVE	WITHOUT	WITH	DIFFERENCE
Month 6	50,800 €	45,300 €	5,500 €
Month 12	101,600 €	72,100 €	29,500 €
Month 18	152,400 €	98,900 €	53,500 €
Month 24	**203,200 €**	**125,700 €**	**77,500 €**

Without = 2,480 h × 40 € + the Asana licence, every year. **With** = 18,500 € once, then 1,340 h × 40 € and no Asana. Crossover in **month 5**, then roughly **4,000 € a month** in the BU's favour.

THE THIRD LEVER: ASANA GOES

2,400 € / year

Asana public list price, Starter tier, 10.99 $ per user per month billed annually, on an assumed **20 seats**. On the Advanced tier at 24.99 $ it is 5,500 € a year.

GIVE US THE REAL SEAT COUNT AND TIER AND THIS LINE BECOMES EXACT. IT IS THE ONE NUMBER IN THIS PACK THAT IS AN INVOICE, NOT AN ESTIMATE.

THE GAP AT 24 MONTHS, BY RATE

25 € / h	43,300 €
30 € / h	54,700 €
40 € / h	77,500 €
50 € / h	100,300 €

Doing nothing is not the free option. It is the 203,200 € option, and that is before the growth you are planning for.

The decision on the table today

DEADLINES HELD

Every deliverable lands on the day agreed. If one will not, you hear it from me 48 hours before, not after.

TRANSPARENCY

A weekly 30-minute checkpoint, a shared workspace updated live, and an answer within 24 hours.

100% ADOPTION GUARANTEE

If a deliverable does not match the agreed brief, I rebuild it at no extra cost. We iterate until the system is actually used.

PHASE 2A + 2B · COMMITTED TOGETHER · FIXED FEE

Notion Orchestration Layer

18,500 €

EXCL. VAT · 50% AT KICKOFF, 50% AT GO-LIVE

Against 28,500 to 57,000 € given back every year, plus the Asana licence retired. Back in the BU inside the first year, and 77,500 € ahead at 24 months.

EVERYTHING IN THE FEE

8 databases, the 12-phase lifecycle and the vendor funnel, 10 automations, the seven morning screens, the Meeting Agent, the fraud review queue, the SOP pack, two full days of training, and a 30-day adoption window under the 100% adoption guarantee.

GO-LIVE 23 OCTOBER 2026 · RATE PREFERENTIAL TO THE TWO PHASES TAKEN SEPARATELY

OPTIONS, PRICED SEPARATELY, DECIDED WHENEVER YOU WANT

- A · Vendor portal on quote
- B · Client progress portal on quote
- C · Agentic pack on quote
- D · XTRF read-only sync 3,200 - 4,800 €
- E · Weekly payment run on quote
- Operate · ongoing run 1,500 € / month

THANK YOU

One place where the work actually lives.

Thank you to the nine of you who gave three hours of honesty, and to Melina and Valeria for walking me through the systems underneath. That is the raw material this proposal is built on.

DECISION	KICKOFF	GO-LIVE
Green light on Phase 2	Week of 14 September	23 October 2026

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